As you drive down the road, the gauges on your dashboard are the same as the gauges in the cars around you. There are highway signs that tell you how fast you should go and what you should do. Everyone on the road has gone through the same driving tests to get a driver's license and knows the same basic stuff about driving.

Agile development is nothing like this. The people involved in delivering a software product have different roles and different backgrounds. Their idea of what *good* means can vary substantially.

- A developer might think that *good* means a well-engineered piece of software.
- A product owner might define *good* as more features delivered.
- A project manager may think *good* means it was done on time and within budget.

Even though everyone is doing something different, they're all headed down the same road.

So now picture a bunch of people driving down the same road in different vehicles with totally different gauges. They all need to get to the same place, yet they're all using different information to get there. They can follow each other down the road, but when they pull over to figure out how the trip is going, each has different ideas of what the gauges in their vehicle are telling them.

Agile is a partnership between product owners and product creators. To make the most out of that partnership you need to smooth out the communication differences by turning the data you're already generating in your development process into agreed-upon metrics that tell you how your team is doing.

Let's look at some universal problems that end up getting in the way of a common understanding of agile metrics:

- Agile definitions of measurement are not straightforward.
- Agile deviates from textbook project management.